1991	2	1	50
1996	1	1	100
1998	1	1	100
1999	2	1	50
2004	2	2	100
2009	4	4	100
2014	7	3	42.8
2019	9	4	44.4%

Source: Analysis by Nalin Mehta with Rishabh Srivastava of Lok Sabha data and Muslim-dominant seats, https://pollniti.com/live.html

This is not to say that the BJP grew on Hindu issues alone. An election is seldom won on a single issue. Yet, the electoral results showed a correlation between Muslim-significant seats and wins for the party, repeating over two decades. Eleven of Assam's thirty-three districts are Muslim-majority districts.[151] The BJP's initial bridgeheads mostly came in these districts as it became the political vehicle for articulating Hindu unease over Muslim migration. Unlike the Hindi heartland, Assam never had a Hindu–Muslim political fault line until recently. In fact, until the early 1990s, the primary praxis of identity politics in the state was on the question of language: Bengali speakers vs non-Bengali speakers.

Although the BJP had a presence in Assam from the 1950s onwards and focused on issues of illegal Muslim migration from Bangladesh from the very beginning, its message found little traction. Within a week of its formation, in the early 1950s, the Jan Sangh had set up an ad hoc committee to organise an Assam branch under the presidentship of I.P. Barooah, but it made little headway.[152] The growth of the BJP in the early 1980s was 'halted', as H. Srikanth has argued, 'to a considerable extent by the Assamese caste Hindus, who used to see BJP only as a Marwari party'. The Assam movement to protect indigenous populations from illegal migrants from Bangladesh defined the state's politics from the late 1970s to the 1980s. But it was focused on *all* outsiders—whether Hindu or Muslim—not on religious identity. As one observer put it,[153]